



The Voice of Rain

Q1. There is a parallel drawn between rain and music. Which words indicate this? Explain the similarity between the two.

Answer: The following words/phrases indicate the parallel between rain and music. Poem of Earth 'eternal I rise impalpable out of land and the bottomless sea' 'For song duly with love returns. Both originate from a source, rise up, reach fulfillment, wander about whether cared about or not and finally return to the source of origin with love.

Q2. How is the cyclic movement of rain brought out in the poem?

Answer: Rain water rises untouched out of the land and deep sea and gathers in the sky, where it changes form, and then comes down to earth to bathe the dry tiny particles of dust layers and all that lies buried under it. Then it returns to the place of its origin. Science textbooks indicate that water vapours from the rivers and ocean rise up to the sky due to the intense heat. They assume the form of clouds and after condensation drops down as rain. The water flows back through rivers to the seas and oceans.

Q3. Why are the last two lines put within brackets?

Answer: The last two lines contain a comment about (music and its cycle. These differ from the first nine lines. The first two lines are the voice of the poet whereas lines three to nine are spoken by rain. The cycle of song is put within brackets to mark the difference in speakers but similarity in content.

Q4. "Behind the apparent simplicity, the poem hides a deep meaning." What exactly does the poem convey to the reader?

Answer: The poem is not merely a description of the life-cycle of rain. It has a deeper meaning. Rain is a poem or thing of beauty of Earth) and so is song or music. The comparison between rain and music and their function making the Earth pure and beautifully conveys the eternal role of natural phenomenon and art in real life.

Q5. There are two voices in the poem. Who do they belong to? Which lines indicate this?

Answer: The poem contains two voices. The first is of the rain, and the second is of the poet himself. "And who art thou? Said I to the soft-falling shower," is the voice of the poet and "I am the Poem of Earth, said the voice of the rain" is the voice of rain.